



that router is not running while the office is closed. Bhatt shared, "One of our customers is using ePlug to turn off their Wi-Fi routers every night after 11 pm. He is using it both at his office and home. It has also greatly helped him to restrict his children's access to the Internet after a certain time of the day."

Smart switches are also being used in data-critical environments like data centres and banks. "Many IT companies are using Smarteefi to automate their data centre schedules. These applications are not just time-based functions but rather operations based on real-time situations. For instance, they are using smart systems to turn off certain units when the load is less and turn them back on when the load increases," Gahlaut shared.

Smart switch customisations are enabling banks to manage their systems while complying with their security policies. Gahlaut mentioned, "We customise our smart appliances in such a way that the banks can control their systems without having to connect to the Internet. For security purposes, they need to connect their system to their intranet only."

Keeping in mind the limitation of 16A current capacity, industries are using smart plugs to automate some of their machines. Sharma shared, "There are customers from specific

industrial and manufacturing units who wish to automatically turn off their machines at predetermined time intervals. Betty is being put to such uses as well, keeping the power capacities in mind."

Gahlaut explained with an example, "Suppose you are a phone manufacturer and you have to perform 50 test cases of switching on and off the phone under test. You can schedule these 50 test cases by connecting your test instrument with the smart appliance instead of directly controlling from the power input. Once the tests are done, the testing instrument will automatically be turned off."

Smart plugs can be quite useful for managing medical equipment as well as regular appliances at medical facilities. Gahlaut cited an example, "A senior doctor from the oncology department in AIIMS bought three of our smart appliances. He is using these to control some of his instruments alongside electrical appliances. We are also connected with 8-10 nursing homes who are buying our product to manage their medical equipment better."

Controlling air-conditioner usage is the biggest application—be it at homes, offices or business chambers. Scheduling water pumps according to odd timing of water supply is another popular use case.

Smart switches are also used to control televisions, coffee machines, microwaves or any kind of pluggable devices automatically or remotely as required.

Most smart devices provide comparative analytics of the power consumption data of all devices, enabling users to know which appliance is drawing more power and how it can be managed. Thus smart plugs help to reduce energy wastage and cut down electricity expenses. **EFY**

—Paromik Chakraborty, technical journalist, EFY

Ease Of Use, Scalability And Non-Destructive Installation Are Key Benefits Of Wireless Lighting

➤ Smart lighting technology is all set to evolve power usage patterns. Complete control on power usage will lead to mass savings for commercial organisations in the near future. Nidhi Arora, executive editor, EFY magazine, talks to Ripu Daman Sharma, country sales manager for Lutron Electronics, about how smart lighting will lead towards building smart organisations, smart homes and thereby a smarter nation